PRACTICE 05 · 10-MINUTE

The Uncertainty *Practice*

Uncertainty→Grounded Presence

DURATION	WHEN	LEVEL	STEPS
10 minutes	Any time	Beginner	4

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Uncertainty feels threatening because the mind is built to anticipate. When it can't find a clear outcome to prepare for, it generates anxiety instead. The scanning doesn't stop. The alertness stays on.

The body tightens. The breath shortens. Decisions become harder. Not because you lack information, but because your nervous system has decided the absence of certainty is itself a threat. This practice is here to remind your body that you are safe in the present, even without knowing what comes next.

> *"I can meet what comes. I don't need to know it first."*

A note before you begin. The mind will try to solve its way through this practice. Let it observe instead. The grounding in step two works through the body, not through reasoning. Stay with the physical sensations. They're doing the work.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- A quiet place to sit
- Something to write with
- Something to track time
- A steady object nearby
- 10 uninterrupted minutes

Optional: Frankincense or cedarwood essential oil. Both support grounding when the mind is scanning ahead.

PRACTICE OVERVIEW

> Uncertainty is not a problem to solve. It's a state to move through. This practice uses journalling to name what the mind is doing, then uses the body to interrupt the scanning and return you to the present moment.

1	Journalling	3 min
2	Body Grounding	4 min
3	Presence Breath	2 min
4	Close	1 min

THE PRACTICE

01 Journalling

3 MINUTES

The first step is to name what the mind is scanning for. Not to resolve it. Not to find answers. Just to put words to the loop so it stops running invisibly underneath everything else.

> Sit comfortably. Hold or rest your hand on the steady object. Take one slow breath.
>
> **In your journal, answer honestly:**
>
> - What outcome am I trying to predict or control right now?
> - What am I most afraid will happen if I don't know what comes next?
> - What would it mean to be okay right now, without knowing?
>
> Write without reframing. You're naming the uncertainty, not correcting it.

02

02 Body Grounding

4 MINUTES

Feet on the floor, present and still

When the mind is scanning ahead, the body loses its sense of where it is right now. Proprioceptive grounding, simply pressing into the floor and noticing physical sensation, pulls attention back into the present. It interrupts the scanning at the physiological level, not just the cognitive one.

> Sit or stand with both feet flat on the floor. Press them gently but firmly downward.
>
> Notice the weight of your body. Notice the surface beneath you. Notice the temperature of your hands.
>
> Hold the steady object. Feel its weight and texture. Let your attention rest on what is physically here, right now.
>
> If the mind pulls forward, gently return to sensation. You don't have to think your way back. Just feel what is under your feet.
>
> Stay here for a few minutes. There is nothing to figure out in this moment.

03 Presence Breath

2 MINUTES

A slow, extended exhale activates the parasympathetic nervous system and signals safety

to the body. It's one of the fastest ways to shift from threat state to present state. You don't need to calm down. Just breathe into what's here.

> Inhale slowly through the nose for 4 counts. Hold for 4. Exhale through the mouth for 6 to 8 counts.
>
> Repeat for several rounds. Let the exhale be longer than the inhale each time.
>
> Notice what is present. Notice what is stable. Notice that you are here.

04 Close

1 MINUTE

Place one hand on your heart. Choose one statement that feels grounded and true right now.

"I don't need to know what comes next to be okay right now."

"I can respond when something actually happens."

"This moment doesn't need my vigilance."

> Take one slow breath. Then gently return to your day.

PRACTICE COMPLETE

You don't need to predict what's coming next to be okay right now.

Today, you let your system stop scanning for a moment. That matters. You can meet things as they arrive. Return to this practice whenever uncertainty starts pulling you out of the present.

Creating inner balance, one grounded pause at a time.

ENJOY YOUR DAY